

SHUHITA BHATTACHARJEE

Faculty of English Literature, Gender & Sexuality Studies, Design

Assistant Professor, Department of Liberal Arts,
Adjunct Professor, Department of Design,
Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad, India

Areas of Interest: Nineteenth-Century Studies, Religion and Postsecular Studies, South Asian Literature and Culture, Gender & Sexuality Studies, Postcolonial Studies, Artificial Intelligence and Literature, Posthuman Studies, Graphic Novels, Cultures and History of Design, Hijab Narratives, Queer Studies

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Hyderabad, India

Education

● PhD in English

Department of English,
University of Iowa, USA

2009-2015

● MPhil in English

Department of English,
Jadavpur University

2008

● Masters in English

Department of English,
Jadavpur University

2006

● Bachelors in English

Department of English,
Jadavpur University
(Awarded a National Scholarship)

2004

Experience



Assistant Professor at IIT Hyderabad

2018 - continuing

Assistant Professor, English Literature and Gender & Sexuality Studies,
Department of Liberal Arts
&

Adjunct Professor, Design Cultures, Theories and History,
Department of Design

Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad, India



Assistant Professor at Presidency University

2013 - 2018

English Literature

Department of English, Presidency University, Kolkata, India



Lecturer (TA) at University of Iowa

2009 - 2013

English Literature and Cultural Studies

Independent Course Designer and Instructor,
Department of English, University of Iowa, USA



Lecturer at HMM College, Kolkata

2008 - 2009

Adjunct Faculty of English Literature

Department of English, HMM College, Kolkata, India

Projects

Academic Projects

- India Coordinator, Research Grant for "Victorian Diversities Research Network", UKRI Arts and Humanities Research Council (AHRC), 2023 [IIT Hyderabad as Partner Organization]; MOU signed, **Project amount: GBP 42,437**;
Event: 2026 International Symposium at IITH]

Social Sector Projects



- Principal Investigator, ICSSR Funded Project, "Adolescent Sexual Health Education through Picture Books: Designing and Disseminating Picture Books on Sexual Health---Taking the Conversation to Children, Doctors, Teachers [Ongoing till 2026; 18 Lakhs]
- Co-Principal Investigator, ICSSR Funded Project, 'Intimacy and Risk: Understanding Violence taking place through Queer Dating Applications in Contemporary India' [Completed; 15 lakhs]
- Violence against Women and HIV/AIDS-I, School of Women's Studies (Jadavpur University), in collaboration with ActionAid (India); Co-author of the Report (2006-2007)
- Violence Against Women and HIV/AIDS- II: Media Campaigns in West Bengal, School of Women's Studies (Jadavpur University), in collaboration with ActionAid (India) (2007-2008)
- Gender Politics and the National HIV/AIDS Draft Bill, School of Women's Studies (Jadavpur University), in collaboration with the National Commission for Women (2007)
- Introduction of Sex Education in the Schools of West Bengal, School of Women's Studies (Jadavpur University) (2007)
- Chairperson of UNICEF's Children's Borough Council set up to conceive, design and execute developmental projects for the children of East India (2001)

Infrastructure established at IIT Hyderabad



Public Humanities Initiative (PHI) Lab

Lab with Design Studio equipment including professional graphic design tablet, compatible computer systems, and high-end digital scanner (Funder: *Indian Council for Social Science Research*)

The lab is a unique space that allows:

- **ENGINEERING-HUMANITIES COLLABORATION:** Humanities and Engineering professionals to work together to design tools for better rural education
- **CREATIVE & PERFORMING ARTS INITIATIVES:** Consultation with creative arts professionals for producing theatre/dance/fine art performances for social welfare in village schools
- **DESIGN OF NATIONAL VISUAL MATERIAL:** Designers and Humanities experts to collaborate on visual material for circulation across schools, colleges, offices, hospitals, and ministries, along with circulation through NCERT
- **AUDIO-VISUAL ARCHIVE** (National Website for Survivor Accounts): Confidential interviews with adolescent sexual abuse/assault survivors to build a website in collaboration with ministries

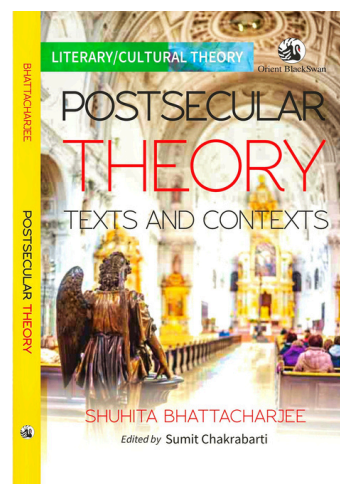
Centres and Networks Founded from IITH

- Founder and Coordinator, *Public Humanities Initiative* (PHI) Centre, IIT Hyderabad, 2025
- Founder and Coordinator, Nineteenth-Century Diversities Research Network (NCDRN), South Asia Chapter, 2025: First 19-Century Studies scholarly network in South Asia (Grant: UKRI)

Publications

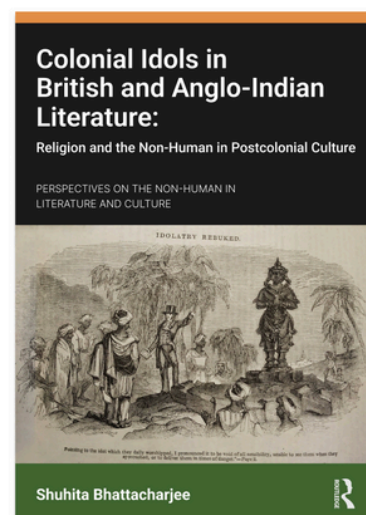
Books (Monographs)

Postsecular Theory: Texts and Contexts. Orient Blackswan (Literary/Cultural Theory Series), 2023.

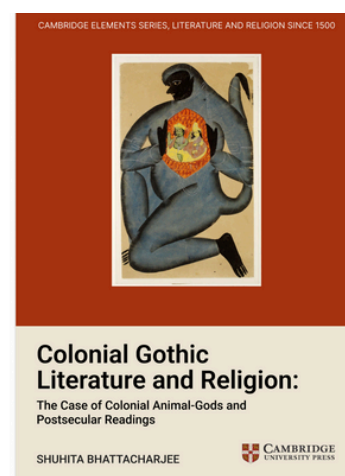


Colonial Idols in British and Anglo-Indian Literature: Religion and the Non-Human in Postcolonial Culture. Perspectives on the Non-Human in Literature and Culture. Routledge, USA [In the Press, March 2026].

[Strongly endorsed by eminent scholars for the book cover:
Professor Carolyn Oulton
Professor Florence Boos]



Colonial Gothic Literature and Religion: The Case of Colonial Animal-Gods and Postsecular Readings. Cambridge Elements Series, Literature and Religion since 1500, Cambridge University Press. Forthcoming 2027. [Confirmed and in the process of contract-signing for publication in 2027]



HIV and Violence Against Women: A Study. ActionAid Kolkata, India, 2008. [Co-author]

International Reception of the Books:

Reviews for the first monograph, ***Postsecular Theory: Texts and Contexts*. Orient Blackswan, 2023.**

The monograph been very highly praised and positively reviewed in international/national journals and newspapers:

- *Economic and Political Weekly* (Vol. 60, Issue No. 22, 31 May, 2025)
- *Victoriographies: A Journal of the Long Nineteenth Century* (Volume 14 Issue 3, Page 282-284, ISSN 2044-2416, by Michelle Taylor)
- The *Times Group* Bengali daily, *Ei Samay* (5 March 2023)

Endorsements for the second monograph, ***Colonial Idols in British and Anglo-Indian Literature: Religion and the Non-Human in Postcolonial Culture*. Perspectives on the Non-Human in Literature and Culture. Routledge, USA [In the Press, March 2026]**

Carolyn Oulton [Professor of Victorian Literature; Co-Director International Centre for Victorian Women Writers; Canterbury Christ Church University, UK; carolyn.oulton@canterbury.ac.uk]:

- *Bhattacharjee's book connects an impressive range of sources----museum catalogues and periodical advertisements to fiction and art---- examining idol-objects and their unexpected appearances in nineteenth-century literature and culture. Bhattacharjee shows how idol-objects complicated and disrupted cultural hierarchies, moving across boundaries/categories with varying levels of agency and power.*

Florence Boos [Professor Emerita, University of Iowa, USA; florence-boos@uiowa.edu]:

- *Bhattacharjee's exhaustively-researched volume is a masterful study of British responses to Hindu art, and offers a wealth of new resources and original insights. No one invested in museum history, Indian material culture, transimperial literature, or the psychology of cross-cultural exchange, can ignore this uniquely informative work.*

Q1 Journals, with National/International Collaborations:

1. "Ancestral Voices Propheying War': Investigating the Legacy of the 1947 Partition in the 21st-Century Indian Cultural Imagination of Nuclear War." *South Asian Review*. 2023. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1080/02759527.2023.2277969> [Co-Author Souvik Kar]
2. "Anger as a feminist instrument of the female superhero in Abhijit Kini's Angry Maushi trilogy." *Journal of Graphic Novels and Comics*. 1-25. 2024. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1080/21504857.2024.2378899> [Co-Author Deblina Rout]
3. "Dark Humour and the Female Performance of Subversion in South-Asian Diaspora Cinema: Chadha's *Rich Deceiver*, *It's A Wonderful Afterlife*, and *What Do You Call An Indian Woman Who's Funny?*" *South Asian Studies*. 2022. DOI: 10.1080/02666030.2022.2035085
4. Study of *Capital Designs: Australia House and Visions of an Imperial London*. Eileen Chanin. In *Victorian Studies*. 64.1 (2021).
5. "'Even God seems to have gone into hiding': Hindu Nationalism, Indian Nuclear Scientists, and the Quest for the United States of India in *Anushakthi Amma* (2004)." *South Asia: Journal of South Asian Studies*. Vol. 49, no.2, April 2026. (Forthcoming; Co-Author Souvik Kar, Dibyadyuti Roy)
6. "'Like Fiction, only considerably more dangerous': South Asia, Nuclear Surveillance, and twenty-first century Indo-American Novels of Geopolitical Intrigue." *Surveillance and Society*. Forthcoming 2026. (Co-Author Souvik Kar, Dibyadyuti Roy)
7. "Graphic Interventions on Child Sexual Abuse: The Case of Indian Narratives." *Visual Studies*. (Forthcoming; Co-Author Deblina Rout)

Scopus-Indexed Journal Articles:

1. Atomic Priesthood(s) and the "Knowing Smirk" of the Wandering Jew in *A Canticle for Leibowitz*." *ANQ: A Quarterly Journal of Short Articles, Notes and Reviews*. 1-5. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1080/0895769X.2025.2467169> (Co-Author Souvik Kar)
2. "'A Punch Back, . . . a Contagious Guffaw': Feminist Humor in The Marvelous Mrs. Maisel and the Professionalization of the Rebellious Laugh." *Studies in American Humor*. 9.1 (2023). DOI: <https://doi.org/10.5325/studamerhumor.9.1.0031>
3. "The Insurgent Invasion of Anti-Colonial Idols in Late-Victorian Literature: Richard Marsh and F. Anstey." *English Literature in Transition*. 61.1 (Jan 2018).
4. "Of Mahatmas and Chelas: Theosophy and the 'Cartography of the Supernatural' in Richard Marsh and F. Anstey." In *Victorian Popular Fictions Journal*. 1.2 (2019). DOI: <https://doi.org/10.46911/ZWIS2654>
5. "'Not a muscle at my command': Mesmeric Trance, Consent, and #MeToo in Richard Marsh." *Nineteenth-Century Gender Studies*. 16.2 (2020).
6. Study of *Imperial Women Writers in Victorian India: Representing Colonial Life, 1850-1910*. In *English Literature in Transition*. 62.3 (May 2019).

Book Chapters in International Edited Collections (Scopus-Indexed)

"Criminal Mesmerism, Culpability, and the Automaton in Richard Marsh," *Victorian Automata: Mechanism and Agency in the Nineteenth Century*. Cambridge University Press, 2024. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1017/9781009110129>

"Producing the Vampire: Victorian Afterlives of the 'Un-Dead' and Contemporary Sexual Crime in the Cinema of Anushka Sharma." In *Women in Contemporary Indian Films and Media*. Edited by Aysha Iqbal Viswamohan. Routledge. 2024. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.4324/9781003583851>

"'Rosy Ki Khwaheeshein': Scripted Romance and Acquaintance Rape in Alankrita Shrivastava's Oeuvre of Female Desire," In *Women Filmmakers in Contemporary Hindi Cinema: Looking through their Gaze*. Edited by Aysha Iqbal Viswamohan. Palgrave Macmillan, 2023. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-10232-5_13

"Shockwaves of Rape and Shattering of Power in the Contemporary Indian Web-Series: The Case of *Delhi Crime*, *Made in Heaven*, and *Judgement Day*." In *The Politics of Emotional Shockwaves*. Edited by Ana Falcato and Sara Graça da Silva. Lisbon: Palgrave Macmillan, 2021. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-56021-8_6

"The Colonial Idol, the Animalistic, and the New Woman in the Imperial Gothic of Richard Marsh." In *Gothic Animals: Uncanny Otherness and the Animal With-Out*. Edited by Ruth Heholt and Melissa Edmundson. London: Palgrave Macmillan, 2020. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-34540-2_15

"Reimagining Reluctance: The South-Asian Diaspora and Global 'Homing' in Mira Nair's *The Reluctant Fundamentalist*." In *Diasporic Inquiries into South Asian Women's Narratives: Alien Domiciles*. Edited by Shilpa Daithota Bhat. Lanham, Boulder, New York, London: Lexington Books, 2020.

"Relocating Home and Diasporising the South Asian Queer in Divakaruni and Patil." In *Beyond Trishanku: Diaspora Poetics and Homing in South Asian Women's Writing*. Edited by Shilpa Daithota Bhat. Lanham, Boulder, New York and London: Lexington Books, 2018.

Encyclopedic entry on 'Mira Nair.' *Contemporary Literary Criticism*. Gale Database. Volume 524. 2024.

Edited Journal Volumes

Guest Editor of *Nineteenth-Century Gender Studies*. "(Un)disciplining Within the Nineteenth Century: Historical Hybridity in Self-Reflexive Writing by Women." *Nineteenth-Century Gender Studies*. Summer 2024. Joint Editor, Michelle M. Taylor.

International Awards/ Honours

Awards

- **Charles Wallace Grant for International Archival Research (2020); Cash Prize 1.5 lakhs, Mention in the Charles Wallace Archive**
- Marcus Bach Fellowship (2015); Cash Prize USD 10,700; Mention in the Fellowship Archive
- Robert L. Platzman Fellowship, University of Chicago; Cash Prize USD 6000; Mention in the Fellowship Archive (2013)
- Stanley Award for International Research, University of Iowa; Cash Prize USD2500; Mention in the Fellowship Archive (2013)
- Frederick P.W. McDowell Dissertation Award (2014)
- Summer Dissertation Fellowship, University of Iowa (2013)
- Discussion Leader at the Lumen Christi Institute's Seminar ("Christianity, the Unity of Knowledge, and the Secularized Academy"), University of Chicago (2013)
- American Association of University Women (AAUW) Fellowship, 2014 (As Alternate)

International Invitations on Global Panel of Experts

- Project Advisor, *"Mapping Religion in the Global Anglophone Novel, 1890–1980 (MaRGAN)" Project*
- Expert, *Canada India Research Centre for Learning and Engagement (CIRCLE); University of Guelph, Canada*
- Expert, *Religion and Spiritualities Caucus, North American Victorian Studies Association*

International Editorial Boards

- Editorial Board Member, *Cambridge Elements Series*, 'Literature and Religion since 1500' (Cambridge University Press)
- Co-Editor, *Journal of Victorian Culture* (Oxford University Press)
- *Nineteenth-Century Gender Studies* (Guest Editor); <https://www.ncgsjournal.com/>

Reviewer Boards (Book Presses/Journal Boards)

- Routledge UK (Book Press)
- Routledge India (Book Press)
- *Victorian Studies* (Q1, Indiana University Press)
- *PMLA* (Q1, Modern Language Association of America)
- *Contemporary South Asia* (Taylor and Francis)
- *Quarterly Review of Film and Video* (Taylor and Francis)
- *Global South Literary Studies* (Taylor and Francis)
- *Victorian Network*
- *Tulsa Studies in Women's Literature*
- *Wagadu: A Journal of Transnational Women's and Gender Studies*
- *Journal of International Women's Studies*
- *Pertanika Journal of Social Sciences and Humanities*
- *Espacio, Tiempo y Educación*

Administrative Positions at IIT Hyderabad

- Faculty Expert, **Internal Complaints Committee (ICC)** (2024-ongoing)
- Faculty Expert, **Disciplinary Action Committee (DAC)** (2021-2023)
- Member, Advisory Board, **Rural Development Centre (RDC)** (2025-ongoing)
- Faculty Expert, **Women's Cell and CGC (Committee for Gender Concerns)** (2020-2024)
- Chair, **Departmental Postgraduate Committee** (2020-2023)
- Departmental Faculty Representative, **Office of International Relations**, Department of Liberal Arts (2022-ongoing)
- Departmental Faculty Representative, **Sunshine Counselling Cell** (2019-2023)
- Member, **Departmental Funds Committee** (2025-ongoing)
- Faculty Coordinator, **Qurve** (Campus Alliance Group for theLGBTQIA+), IIT Hyderabad (2021-ongoing)

National-Level Responsibilities

- Board Member, **Salar Jung Museum**, Hyderabad
- External Expert, Internal Complaints Committee (ICC), **Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT)**, Delhi and Bengaluru, Government of India (2022-ongoing)
- Expert, Gender Studies, **University of Hyderabad**
- Faculty Expert, Gender Studies, UGC, **HRDC at Maulana Azad National Urdu University (MANUU)**, Hyderabad
- Faculty Expert on 'Higher Education and Society,' **Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya National Mission**, Indian Institute of Information Technology Design and Manufacturing (**IIITDM**), **Kancheepuram**
- Expert, Recruitment Panel, **Chaitanya Bharathi Institute of Technology**, Hyderabad
- Faculty Expert, **Presidency University**, Kolkata
- Faculty Expert, **Sreenidhi College**, Hyderabad

National/International Events Organized

- **UKRI International Symposium** on Nineteenth-Century Studies and South-Asian Connections (Title: "Transnational Encounters in/through South Asia: Victorian Routes of Influence and Affect"), **8-9 January 2026** (Funder: UKRI; IITH as the global partner in this UKRI grant) [Upcoming]
- **NPTEL-supported national-level Faculty Development Program (FDP)** on "Gender Rights, Sensitization, and Safety in the Workplace: A Practice-Based Interdisciplinary Approach"; **March 2026** [Upcoming]
- **Launch and Inauguratory Conference of the *Public Humanities Initiative* (PHI), March 2025** (Funder: **Indian Council of Social Science Research (ICSSR)** (Covered in Deccan Chronicle and Namaste Telangana)
- **International Conference on Nineteenth-Century Studies** (Three-Day Conference with USA-UK-India partnership, Presidency University, Kolkata, **2017**)

Social Outreach and Community Engagement

- **School workshops on "Gender Safety and Sexuality Education"** in Hyderabad and peri-urban areas (2024-ongoing)
- Mentoring Student Volunteers and Designing Modules on "**Social Awareness, Mental-Well-Being, and Gender Safety**" for implementation in **Kandi Village Schools, Rural Development Centre (RDC)** (2025-ongoing)
- Multiple **Mental Well-Being Workshops with Interactive Art Installations** for **school children on IIT Hyderabad campus**, March 2025
- "**Gender Rights and Safety Training**": A Public Lecture, **Lamakaan, Hyderabad** (2023)
- **Yearly talks for "Gender Sensitization and Safety"** as expert for **CGC, Orientation of IIT Hyderabad students** (2020-24)
- **Continuous Public Lectures/Talks on "Gender Sensitization and Safety"** for public awareness in HRDC at Maulana Azad National Urdu University (**MANUU**), **University of Hyderabad**, Centre for Development of Telematics, Govt of India (**C-DOT**), NGOs in Kolkata, **Himachal Pradesh University** etc

• **TEACHING FEEDBACK**

(Average; across PG and UG courses): **4.5/5**

CURRICULUM DEVELOPMENT

- MA, *Development Studies*
- MA, *Health, Gender, Society*
- Upcoming 2026: BA *Liberal Arts*
- Upcoming 2026: Major in *Creative and Performing Arts*

NEW COURSES (Designed and Taught at IITH)

- **Courses on Health, Society, and Gender** (LA6730: "Gendering (Un)wellness narratives: A literary-cultural Perspective")
- **Course on Religion, Literature, Society** (LA6570: The Rise of Postsecular Studies in Literary Theory: Reviewing Ideologies of Religion and the Secular)
- **Course on social aspects of Development Studies** (LA5080: Cultural Perspectives on Development: Examining Race, Class, Gender)
- **Course on practical aspects of gender practice for workplaces and classrooms** (LA6863: Gender in Theory and Practice)
- **Popular courses on Graphic Narratives and Creative Design for UG students and Design Department students** (DS4093: Graphic Narratives: Genres of Literature and Products of Design; LA1590 Graphic Novels as Literature)
- **Popular course on Artificial Intelligence and its Social Implication** (LA1480 Artificial Intelligence in Literature and Popular Culture)

Other Courses for IITH Platforms

- **OAT Course**, "Gender in Theory and Practice" (July–Nov 2025)
- **Certificate Course**, "Gender in Theory and Practice" (July–Nov 2025)
- **NPTEL Course**, "Religion and Literature: Tracing the 'Secular' and the 'Religious' in English Literary Studies through Postsecular Theory" (Upcoming, July 2026)
- Faculty Expert on 'Higher Education and Society,' **Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya National Mission** (MMMNT; Indian Government Higher Education Faculty Training Scheme), IITH (2023–ongoing)
- Faculty Expert, **Navodaya Teachers' Training Programme**, IITH (2024–ongoing)

TALKS (International/National)

- Invited talks at George Mason University (2024), Kingston University (2023)
- Talks delivered at Midwest Victorian Studies Association Conference (2021), Victorian Popular Fiction Association Conference, University of Greenwich and Loughborough University (2019, 2022)
- Paper presented at the 'Women in Films, Media and Beyond' Conference organized by University of Guelph, Canada, and Indian Institute of Technology Madras (2021)
- Keynote Speaker at the Department of English Conference, Benares Hindu University, Varanasi, India (2018)
- Invited lectures at Indian Institute of Information Technology Hyderabad (IIITH) (2020)
- Invited Talks on Humanities, Gender, and Literature in the Modern Age, Government PG College Gopeshwar, Uttarakhand (2020)
- Invited paper presentations at Baylor University, Texas (2016), Victorians Institute Journal Conference, North Carolina (2015), Midwest Victorian Studies Association Conference, University of Iowa (2015), University of Warwick (2014), University of Portsmouth (2014), University of Ireland, Galway (2014), University of Glasgow (2014)
- Invited talks on graphic novels at Jadavpur University—SYLFF (Ryoichi Sasakawa Young Leaders Fellowship Fund of Japan's Nippon Foundation) (2018)
- Series of invited lectures at Jadavpur University and Presidency University on Victorian Studies (2016)

Professional Memberships

- Member, Modern Language Association
- Member, North American Victorian Studies Association
- Member, Victorians Institute
- Member, Victorian Popular Fiction Association
- Member, Midwest Victorian Studies Association

Referees

- **Florence Boos**; Professor Emerita, University of Iowa, USA; florence-boose@uiowa.edu
- **Aysha Viswamohan**, Professor, Department of Humanities and Social Sciences, IIT Madras; draysha@iitm.ac.in
- **Lori Peterson Branch**; Associate Professor, Department of English, University of Iowa; lori-branch@uiowa.edu